

3

SET THEORY

3.1 Introduction

Collection of unordered, distinct and well defined objects.

- $\{1, 2\} = \{2, 1\} = \{1, 2, 1\}$ (order & repetition doesn't matter)

Set representation: A $\{1, 2, 3\}$ - Roster form

$A = \{z | z \in \mathbb{N} \text{ } x \leq 3\}$ - Set builder form

- Set with one element is known as singleton set.
- Set with zero element is known as empty set or null set.
- No of elements in a set is known as cardinality of set.
- If a set A contains an element a, it is denoted as:

$$a \in A.$$

3.1.1 Equal sets (Axiom of extension):

Two sets A and B are said to be equal iff they have same set of elements.

$$A = B \Leftrightarrow \forall x (x \in A \Leftrightarrow x \in B) \Leftrightarrow A \subseteq B \wedge B \supseteq A$$

3.1.2 Subset:

- A is said to be subset of B iff every element in A is also then in B. Denoted as $A \subseteq B$

$$\forall x (x \in A \Rightarrow x \in B)$$

3.1.3 Proper subset:

- 'A' is said to be a proper subset of B if every element in A exist in B and $A \neq B$. Denoted as $A \subset B$

$$\text{i.e., } A \subset B \Leftrightarrow \forall x (x \in A \rightarrow x \in B) \wedge \exists x. (x \in B \wedge x \notin A)$$

or

$$A \subset B \Leftrightarrow \forall x (x \in A \rightarrow x \in B) \wedge (|A| \neq |B|)$$

3.1.4 Powerset:

Powerset of a set A is set of all subsets of A . Denoted as $P(A)$

- if $|A| = n$

$$|P(A)| = 2^n$$

- For any set A

$$\phi \subseteq A$$

If $A = \phi$, then

$$\phi \subset A$$

3.1.5 Operations on set:

- (i) **Union:**

$$A \cup B = \{x | x \in A \vee x \in B\}$$

- (ii) **Intersection:**

$$A \cap B = \{x | x \in A \wedge x \in B\}$$

- (iii) **Complement:**

If A is a set,

$$\text{Complement of } A, \bar{A} = A^c = \{x | x \in U \wedge x \notin A\}$$

$$\text{i.e., } \bar{A} = U - A = U \cap \bar{A}$$

- (iv) **Difference:**

$$A/B = A - B = \{x | x \in A \wedge x \notin B\} = A \cap \bar{B}$$

$A - \bar{B}$ is also called complement of B w.r.t. to A .

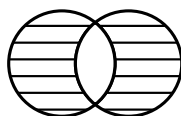
“complement of B in A ”

- (v) **Symmetric Difference:**

$$A \Delta B = \{x | x \in A \vee x \in B, \text{ but not both}\}$$

Since it corresponds to XOR operator, it is also denoted as $A \oplus B$

$$A \Delta B = (A - B) \cup (B - A) = (A \cup B) - (A \cap B)$$



- Two sets are said to be disjoint if their intersection ϕ .

3.1.6 Loss involving set operations:

- $$\left. \begin{array}{l} A \cup A = A \\ A \cap A = A \end{array} \right\} \text{Idempotent law}$$
- $$\left. \begin{array}{l} A \cap \phi = \phi \\ A \cup U = U \end{array} \right\} \text{Domination law}$$
- $$\left. \begin{array}{l} A \cap U = A \\ A \cup \phi = A \end{array} \right\} \text{Identity law}$$
- $$\left. \begin{array}{l} A \cup (B \cup C) = (A \cup B) \cup C \\ A \cap (B \cap C) = (A \cap B) \cap C \\ A \oplus (B \oplus C) = (A \oplus B) \oplus C \end{array} \right\} \text{Associative law}$$

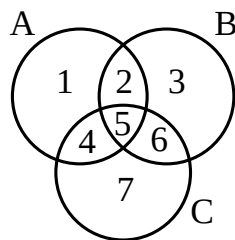
$\therefore$ XOR operation is associative
- $$\left. \begin{array}{l} A \cup (B \cap C) = (A \cup B) \cap (A \cup C) \\ A \cap (B \cup C) = (A \cap B) \cup (A \cap C) \end{array} \right\} \text{Distributive law}$$
- $$\left. \begin{array}{l} A \cup (A \cap B) = A \\ A \cap (A \cup B) = A \end{array} \right\} \text{absorption law}$$
- $$\left. \begin{array}{l} \overline{A \cup B} = \bar{A} \cap \bar{B} \\ \overline{A \cap B} = \bar{A} \cup \bar{B} \end{array} \right\} \text{Demorgan's law}$$

Note:

$$\left. \begin{array}{l} A \oplus B = A \oplus C \Rightarrow B = C \\ A \oplus C = B \oplus C \Rightarrow A = B \end{array} \right\} \text{The proof can be obtained by relating this to XOR operation in logic.}$$

3.1.7 Representation of sets using Venn diagrams:

Rather than direct calculations we sometimes represent sets with Venn diagram and see them as regions.
Let A, B, C be 3 sets



The region 1 is represented by $A \cap \bar{B} \cap \bar{C}$

The region 2 is represented by $A \cap B \cap \bar{C}$

Similarly, we have 8 regions including region outside of A, B, C

The principle of duality:

Let s denote a theorem dealing with the equality at two expressions which involve only operation $\cup$ and $\cap$. The dual of s (sd) (i.e., expression obtained by interchanging $\cup$ and $\cap$) is also a theorem.

Finding dual of $A \subseteq B$

$A \subseteq B$ can be written as

$$A \cup B = B$$

Dual is $A \cap B = B$

i.e., $B \subseteq A$

$\therefore$ Dual of $A \subseteq B$ is $B \subseteq A$

Duality principle should be applied only for general can but no for particular cases

3.1.8 Cartesian Product:

$$A \times B = \{(a, b) | a \in A \wedge b \in B\}$$

- Cartesian product is associative

However

$$\begin{array}{ccc} (A \times B) \times C & \neq & A \times (B \times C) \\ \downarrow & & \downarrow \end{array}$$

it has ordered pairs type $((a, b), c)$ $(a, (b, c))$

$$A \times B \neq B \times A$$

If $A \times B = B \times A$ then $(A = B \vee (A = \phi) \vee (B = \phi))$

- $A \times (B \cap C) = (A \times B) \cap (A \times C)$

$$A \times (B \cup C) = (A \times B) \cup (A \times C)$$

$$\bar{A} \times \bar{B} \neq \overline{A \times B}$$